Ronald E. Straight

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

I bring decades of experience in high-performance backend engineering, from C and Perl to modern Golang and Kubernetes-native Java and Rust microservices. AI coding agents are good collaborators, but they still need someone to tell them when they're about to rimraf something important — with agentic coding you get my unique human experience plus a team of masochistic junior engineers to do all the boring stuff. Work is where I want to swim with my fellow clever rubber ducks.

SKILLS

Programming Languages
Bash, Java, Perl, Golang, C, Python, Rust, Javascript

Technologies
Kubernetes, Git, HTML, CSS, REST API, OCI, AWS, Helm, Docker, Node.js, LLM

Databases
Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MariaDB, Redis, MongoDB

Frameworks
Mason, DBIx::Class, Netty, Dropwizard, React, Spring Boot

Coding Agents
Claude, Codex, OpenClaw, Aider, Antigravity

WORK EXPERIENCE

Househusband at Man and Woman, Living Together — **Oct 2024 - Current**

Buffalo, NY

- Making bread from scratch every other day or so, and sometimes pepperoni rolls.
- Ongoing hacking projects with my artificial friends, including running two multiplayer games in my home server's Kubernetes cluster.

Senior Software Engineer at Synacor — **Feb 2019 - Oct 2024**

Buffalo, NY

- Served as primary developer for the Golang-based Mailbox Locator Service, part of a team converting the Zimbra email/collaboration system to a multi-tenant Kubernetes-native service on Oracle Cloud Infrastructure.
- Contributed to core Zimbra engineering, working on legacy Java codebase with extensive use of remote debuggers.
- Leveraged Golang and Kubernetes expertise to migrate several hundred million user mailboxes — containing sensitive personal communications — from bare-metal servers to Zimbra on Kubernetes, maintaining data integrity throughout.

Senior Software Engineer at Adblade / Solve Media — **May 2013 - Jan 2019**

Buffalo, NY

- Built a high-availability RESTful Data Management Platform (DMP) using Java/Netty, supporting sub-millisecond responses at scale.
- Developed custom dispatching annotations and supported multiple HTTP methods for consumer targeting resources stored in Redis.
- Ported a legacy image conversion REST server from Ruby to Java and migrated a Solaris data center environment to AWS.

Software Engineer III, Team Leader at Kanoodle / Pulse360 / Seevast — **Nov 2004 - Apr 2013**

Buffalo, NY

- Contributed Oracle-specific enhancements upstream to the DBIx::Class open-source ORM framework while developing heavy Perl ad-serving applications.
- Performed Oracle DBA duties, including DDL review and Oracle analytic functions.
- Created a 'RoboDeploy' system for multi-threaded deployment to over 100 servers.

Co-Founder, Software Developer at Netsville — **Jun 1994 - Nov 2004**

Rochester, NY

- Co-founded Netsville and developed 'Hazel,' one of the first e-commerce checkout systems, written in C with a templating language (HZML).

PROJECTS

Logodal

Jan 2026 - Current

https://logodal.com

Skills: Kubernetes, Minikube, Helm, Perl, Rust, React, Networking, Antigravity, Claude, Codex

Multiplayer whimsical word game running on a kind cluster in my bedroom. In active development.

- Developed a custom wordlist server in Rust to handle building lexicons and their rules for any language.
- Configured networking and TLS termination for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at logodal.com.
- Implemented real-time gameplay mechanics using Perl, plus simple intelligent dummy players.
- Use in-cluster ollama to generate personalized quips for the AI players

Card Shoggoths

Jan 2026 - Current

https://poker.fazigu.org

Skills: Kubernetes, Minikube, Helm, Golang, Networking, Antigravity

Multiplayer poker game with a bit of cosmic horror. In active development.

- Implemented the game server in Golang, with a bare bones index.html/css frontend.
- Configured networking for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at poker.fazigu.org.

INTERESTS

Personal Interests

Skills:

Hacking (in the ESR sense),
Tinkering with gadgets,
Fallout/76, Starfield, Cyberpunk,
Arguing with AI, The Love Boat